ARGUMENT IN FAVOR OF MEASURE R

Vote YES on Measure R to modernize Sutter Creek's financial management, improve efficiency, and ensure qualified oversight of public funds.

This measure does not eliminate the Office of City Treasurer. California law requires every city to have a City Treasurer. Instead, it changes the position from an elected office to an appointed one, allowing the City Council to appoint a qualified individual to carry out the Treasurer's legal responsibilities.

Today, the City's professional finance staff performs nearly all of the day-to-day treasury functions, including managing cash flow, reconciling accounts, preparing investment reports, and safeguarding public funds. The elected Treasurer's role is primarily limited to reviewing this work, preparing a summary report, and providing a signature. Maintaining separate elected and administrative roles for the same responsibilities creates unnecessary duplication, administrative inefficiency, and additional election costs.

This proposal reflects the direction taken by cities throughout California. Approximately 64% of California cities now have appointed City Treasurers, recognizing that modern public finance requires specialized knowledge, technical expertise, and continuity. Over the past three decades, dozens of cities have successfully transitioned to appointed treasurers to modernize financial oversight. Most recently, voters in the City of Plymouth approved a similar measure in 2024 by a wide margin.

An appointed City Treasurer remains fully accountable under California law for the safekeeping of public funds and serves under the oversight of the City Council in meetings open to the public. This measure does not reduce transparency or accountability. Instead, it aligns Sutter Creek with the majority of California cities by promoting professional financial management, reducing unnecessary duplication, and making government more efficient while continuing to protect taxpayer dollars.

/s/ Claire Gunselman, Mayor, City of Sutter Creek
/s/ Dan Riordan, Councilmember, City of Sutter Creek
/s/ Bruce Baracco, Retired Planner
/s/ Frank Cunha, Retired Contractor
/s/ Mike Kirkley, Retired Planning Commissioner